**FOR IMMEDIATE RELEASE | October 2026**

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# Mission Aviation Academy Brings National Aviation Career Launch to Tampa International Airport Career Foundations Week

*Pre-Release of "Your Aviation Blueprint" — October 19–23, 2026 | Tampa International Airport*

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**WESLEY CHAPEL, FL — October 2026 —** Mission Aviation Academy (MAA), the aviation education division of Infinity Aero Club Tampa Bay, Inc. (iACT), will participate in Tampa International Airport's Career Foundations Week, October 19–23, 2026, bringing the pre-release of *Your Aviation Blueprint: How to Launch a $1M Aviation Career Without a College Degree* to the students, educators, veterans, and workforce professionals attending the event.

Co-authored by retired naval officer LCDR Ricardo "Tattoo" Foster, USN (Ret.), and retired Marine Corps Major Bruce "BOMBER" Blashka, USMC (Ret.), *Your Aviation Blueprint* is a step-by-step career roadmap for young people, veterans, and career-changers who want to enter aviation without a four-year degree. Eight aviation career tracks. BLS-verified salary data. Tuskegee Airmen lineage. One practical guide built for the next generation.

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## THE EVENT

**What:** TPA Career Foundations Week — Aviation Career Launch & Book Preview

**When:** October 19–23, 2026

**Where:** Tampa International Airport, 4100 George J. Bean Pkwy, Tampa, FL 33607

**Who:** Students, educators, JROTC programs, veterans, workforce professionals, media

**Media:** Live event segment opportunity, WFLA coverage, on-site book preview, digital ARC distribution and pre-order activation

## THE BOOK

*Your Aviation Blueprint* is the only aviation career guide for young people with a direct, documented mentor chain to the Tuskegee Airmen — the 332nd Fighter Group whose discipline and excellence opened the skies for every aviator who followed. That lineage runs from 1941 to the classrooms MAA students sit in today. No other book in this category can make that claim.

The book maps eight aviation career tracks with BLS-verified salary data showing cumulative lifetime earnings between $1.9M and $5.1M per track. The majority require no four-year college degree. A digital Advance Reader Copy (ARC) is available now at **missionaviationacademy.org/yab-arc**. Physical copies available to pre-order at **missionaviationacademy.org/yab-preorder**.

730 FAA credentials issued. Over 1,380 students flown. $790,000+ in funding raised. U.S. and Caribbean reach. The mission was built for the kid who never saw themselves in a cockpit — this book hands them the map.

**SCAN TO DOWNLOAD ARC**
*missionaviationacademy.org/yab-arc*

**SCAN TO PRE-ORDER**
*missionaviationacademy.org/yab-preorder*

## QUOTE

> "*When I was young, nobody handed me a roadmap. I figured it out by failing, by showing up, and by finding mentors who saw something in me I didn't always see in myself. Lt. Col. George Hardy soloed at Tuskegee when the system said he couldn't. His legacy now lives on through me. He reached back for me. Just as he reached back and helped me find my purpose, I now reach back to help you discover yours.*"

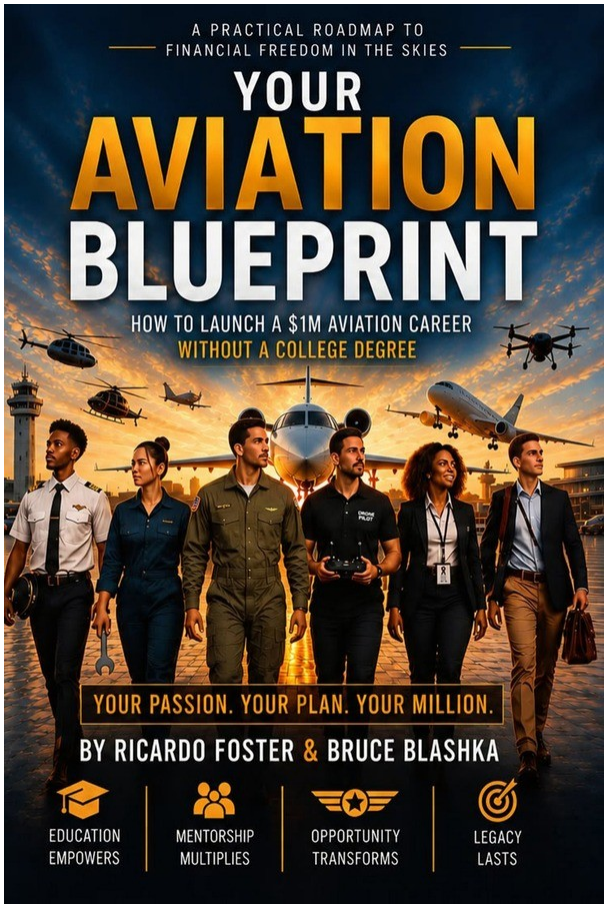
**— LCDR Ricardo "Tattoo" Foster, USN (Ret.),** Founder & CEO, Mission Aviation Academy

## ABOUT MISSION AVIATION ACADEMY

Mission Aviation Academy (MAA) is the academic division of Infinity Aero Club Tampa Bay, Inc. (iACT), a 501(c)(3) nonprofit at Tampa North Aero Park (X39), Wesley Chapel, Florida. Led by two decorated veterans with a combined 76 years in military and commercial aviation, iACT/MAA has issued 730 FAA credentials, flown more than 1,380 students, and raised $790,000+ in funding reaching communities across the U.S. and Caribbean. Flight Plan 2030 is MAA's national initiative to certify 1,000 youth pilots and aviation professionals by 2030.

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*Digital ARC available at missionaviationacademy.org/yab-arc · Pre-order at missionaviationacademy.org/yab-preorder · High-resolution cover, author headshots, and additional press assets available upon request.*




# YOUR AVIATION BLUEPRINT

*How to Launch a $1M Aviation Career Without a College Degree*

**By Ricardo Foster & Bruce Blashka**

Mission Aviation Academy | Infinity Aero Club Tampa Bay, Inc.

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## FOR THE NEXT GENERATION

Aviation is not just pilots. It is mechanics keeping the engines running. Air traffic controllers managing the skies. Drone operators working the cutting edge of technology. Engineers designing what comes next. None of it requires a four-year degree or a trust fund. What it requires is a plan.

*Your Aviation Blueprint* is that plan. Written by two decorated veterans who built a flight school from the ground up for students nobody else was serving, this book gives the next generation of young Americans a step-by-step roadmap into one of the most in-demand, well-paying industries in the world.

## WHAT'S INSIDE

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|---|---|
| **Eight aviation career tracks** | From pilot to engineer, mechanic to drone operator — every path mapped with real salary data and a clear entry point |
| **The $1M roadmap** | BLS-verified cumulative lifetime earnings between $1.9M and $5.1M per career track — the math the title promises, delivered |
| **No college degree required** | The majority of paths covered require FAA certificates, not four-year degrees — and the book tells you exactly which ones and how to get them |
| **How to fund your training** | Scholarships, tax credits, GI Bill, VR&E, 529 plans, WIOA — the funding stack most families never knew existed |
| **The Tuskegee Airmen lineage** | A direct, documented mentor chain from the 332nd Fighter Group to the authors to this book — discipline and legacy woven through every chapter |
| **Real student voices** | Ahviyona Floyd earned three aviation ratings by age 19. Tevin Brown's words — "even if the approach is messy, you can always go around" — are in these pages. |
| **The Three-Room Method** | Nothing is introduced for the first time in the cockpit. Every skill is built in Room One before it's applied in Room Two — so Room Three, the aircraft, is never the first time. |

***"For the kids nobody saw coming."***

*— The dedication*

## ACCESS THE BOOK

**SCAN TO DOWNLOAD ARC**

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For bulk orders, school district licensing, sponsor and media inquiries:

**(813) 445-8889 | admissions@missionaviationacademy.org | missionaviationacademy.org**

*Distributed complimentary at TPA Career Foundations Week, October 19–23, 2026. For evaluation only. © 2026 TDAS / Infinity Aero Club Tampa Bay, Inc. All rights reserved.*